



File No.: EXP202309154

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Once the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD) have been carried out, the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: The complainant exercised the right of Access against the respondent, and their request, as stated by the complainant, did not receive the legally established response.

The complainant provides various documentation related to the complaint filed with this Agency and regarding the exercise of the right exercised.

SECOND: Once the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD was fulfilled, the complaint was admitted for processing, and the respondent entity was granted a hearing period, to present the allegations it deemed appropriate within ten working days.

With its written allegations, the respondent entity has sent this Agency the response to the exercised right. However, it does not provide documentation that proves that the request for the exercise of rights has been duly answered to the interested party.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter, LOPDGDD), the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Data Protection Agency will be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued for its development, and, as long as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

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2/5

II

Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the Regulation and promoting awareness among data controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints filed by an interested party and investigating, as appropriate, the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of data controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In the case that they have designated a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with said authority.

In accordance with this regulation, following the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, prior to the admission for processing of the complaint regarding the exercise of the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, which gives rise to this procedure, the complaint was forwarded to the respondent party for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month and to prove that it had provided the complainant with the due response.

The result of this transfer did not allow for the understanding that the complainant's claims were

satisfied. Consequently, on August 18, 2023, for the purposes provided for in Articles 64.1 and 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint filed was admitted for processing. This admission for processing determines the opening of the present procedure for the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, which states:

“When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of April 27, 2016, it will be initiated by an admission agreement, which will be adopted in accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of this organic law.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure will be six months from the date on which the admission agreement was notified to the complainant. After this period, the interested party may consider their complaint accepted.”

Article 58.2 of the GDPR grants the Spanish Data Protection Agency a series of corrective powers to correct any infringement of the GDPR, including “ordering the data controller or processor to address the requests for the exercise of the rights of the interested party under this Regulation.”

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3/5

III

Rights of Individuals Regarding Personal Data Protection

The rights of individuals regarding personal data protection are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights include access, rectification, erasure, objection, the right to restriction of processing, and the right to data portability.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, the provisions expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR are taken into account. In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the data subject, which shall be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the data subject, and to express its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such request. The burden of proof for compliance with the obligation to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party lies with the data controller.

The communication directed to the data subject regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

Regarding the right of access to personal data, according to the provisions of Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, when the exercise of the right refers to a large amount of data, the controller may request the affected party to specify the "data or processing activities to which the request refers." The right will be considered granted if the controller provides remote access to the data, thus fulfilling the request (although the data subject may request the information referred to in the aspects provided in Article 15 of the GDPR).

The exercise of this right may be considered repetitive more than once during a period of six months, unless there is a legitimate reason for it.

On the other hand, the request will be considered excessive when the affected party chooses a means other than the one offered that incurs a disproportionate cost, which must be borne by the affected party.

IV

Conclusion

In the case analyzed, the complaining party exercised the right of Access regulated in Article 15 of the GDPR and Article 13 of the LOPDGDD.

After the period established in the aforementioned regulations, their request did not receive the legally

required response.

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4/5

During the processing of this procedure, the entity being complained about has responded to this Agency, but does not prove to have addressed the request made by the complainant by sending the required response to their request.

In this regard, it should be noted that it cannot be accepted that the corresponding response can be expressed merely as part of an administrative procedure, such as the submission of allegations regarding this procedure, which was initiated precisely for failing to duly address the request in question.

The aforementioned regulations do not allow for the request to be overlooked as if it had not been made, leaving it without the response that must be issued by the controllers, even in cases where there are no data of the data subject in the entity's files or even in those cases where the requirements are not met, in which case the recipient of such request is also obliged to require the rectification of the observed deficiencies or, if applicable, to deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the controller to provide an express response, in any case, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

Since a copy of the necessary communication that must be directed to the complainant informing them about the decision made regarding the request for the exercise of rights is not attached, it is appropriate to uphold the complaint that initiated this procedure.

V

In view of the cited provisions and others of general application,
the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD the complaint made by A.A.A. considering that the provisions of Article 15 of the GDPR have been infringed and to urge the DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION, with NIF S4711001J, to send to the complaining party, within ten working days following the notification of this resolution, a certification addressing the exercised right of Access or denying it with justification indicating the reasons why the request cannot be attended to, in accordance with the provisions of this resolution. The actions taken as a result of this Resolution must be communicated to this Agency within the same period. Non-compliance with this resolution could result in the commission of an infringement of Article 83.6 of the GDPR, classified as very serious for the purposes of prescription in Article 72.1.m) of the LOPDGDD, which will be sanctioned in accordance with Article 58.2 of the GDPR.

SECOND: NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to the DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

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5/5

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure (Article 18.4 of the LOPD), and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations, a voluntary appeal for reconsideration may be filed before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection, within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution, or directly an administrative contentious appeal before the Administrative Contentious Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and Section 5 of the Fourth Additional Provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Administrative Contentious Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this

act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned legal text.

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